

MACHINE LEARNING

INTRODUCTION AND APPLICATIONS

1. Introduction to Machine Learning (ML)

Definition: Machine Learning is a subset of Artificial Intelligence (AI) that enables machines to learn from data and make decisions or predictions without being explicitly programmed.

Key Points to Remember: Real-Life Analogy:

- ML is based on data and algorithms.
- The system learns patterns from data and improves over time.
- It's used when explicit programming is difficult or impossible.



Supervised Learning:
Like a student learning with an answer key.



Unsupervised Learning:
Like solving a puzzle without knowing picture.

Types of Machine Learning:

Type	Description	Example
Supervised Learning	Learns from labeled data	Predicting house prices
	Learns from unlabeled data	Customer segmentation
Unsupervised Learning	Learns by trial and error	Self-driving cars, games



learning
e.g. solving a puzzle



reinforcement Learning



Reinforcement Learning
Like learning play a video game by getting or penalties.

2. Applications of Machine Learning

Machine Learning is used in almost every industry. Below are common applications, grouped for easy recall.



A. Everyday Applications

- Recommendation Systems
- Netflix, YouTube, Amazon



C. Business & Finance

- Credit Scoring & Fraud Detection
- Stock Price Prediction



B. Autonomous Systems

- Self-driving cars
- Robotics navigation



E. Security

- Face recognition
- Spam filtering

Trick to Memorize:
R B A S
of Basketball

TYPES OF MACHINE LEARNING



SUPERVISED LEARNING

learns from ~~un~~labeled data

ALGORITHMS

- ✓ Linear Regression
- ✓ Decision Trees

APPLICATIONS

Customer segmentation

UNSUPERVISED LEARNING



finds patterns from unlabeled data

ALGORITHMS

★ K-means ■ PCA
= TEACHER-GUIDED LEARNING

REINFORCEMENT LEARNING



learns through trial and error

- Q-Learn PENALTY
- Deep Q-Network ★ ✗



Semi-Supervised Learning combines labeled and unlabeled data



Self-Supervised Learning system generates its own labels



MACHINE LEARNING

1. INTRODUCTION TO MACHINE LEARNING

✓ DEFINITION:

- ML is based on data and algorithms. Learns patterns from data
- Improves over time
- Used when explicit programming is difficult

TYPES OF MACHINE LEARNING



SUPERVISED

Data Type: Labeled
 Goal: Predict labels
 Learning: Teacher-guided
 Real-Life: Student with past papers

UNSUPERVISED

Data Type: Unlabeled
 Goal: Find patterns
 Learning: Discover secrets
 Real-Life: Detective with clues

SEMI-SUPERVISED

Data Type: Few labeled + unlabeled
 Goal: + unlabeled
 Learning: In some answers
 Student + some answers: Student + some answers

REINFORCEMENT

Data Type: No explicit data
 Goal: Maximize reward
 Learning: Learn by doing
 Analogy: Child on bicycle

SUS-R



★ Concept Learning

MADE SIMPLE



What is Concept Learning?



Figuring out the general
idea of a category.

Imagine teaching a
kid what a "bird" is -



EnjoySport Example

Attributes: Sky
AirTemp, Humidity
Wind, Water,
Forecast



Rule-Based Learning

IF Sky is Sunny AND
Water is Warm
THEN EnjoySport = Yes



~~Other Rule~~
~~if Sky is Sunny and Water~~
~~is Warm → EnjoySport = Yes~~

python

if Sky is Sunny and Water
is Warm → EnjoySport = Yes

Hypothesis Space = All Possible Rules

It's like a menu of all
possible rules from a.

Candidate Elimination (Smarter Approach)

- Most general (covers many examples)
- Most specific (just fits positives)



Version Space = All Good Rules

A "box" of all rules
that still work.

Every new example shrinks
the best rule(s) remain.



Decision Trees: Rules in a tree

~~Rules in a tree~~

Real-Word Comparison

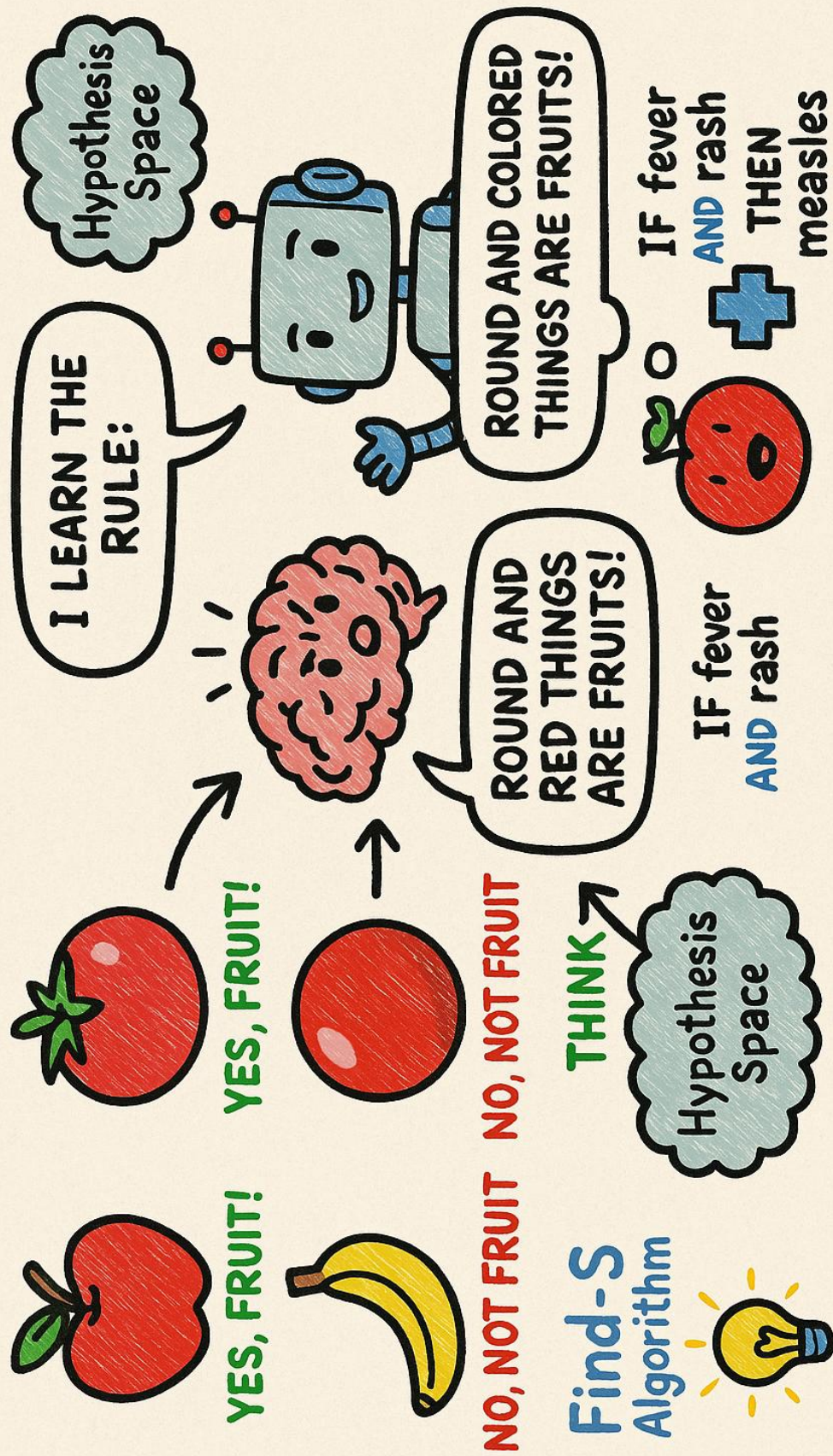
Decision Trees



often perform best.
Accuracy varies by dataset
and daily life

Summary (In Simple rec

CONCEPT LEARNING / RULE-BASED LEARNING



Noisy Data in Machine Learning

Definition:

Noisy data refers to irrelevant, incorrect, or random data that can distort or reduce the accuracy of a machine learning model.



Example:

- ◆ Refine noisy data
- ◆ State problems caused by noise
- ◆ Mention 2 methods to handle noise

Sources of Noise:

- ◆ Human error (wrong labels or data entry)
- ◆ Missing values
- ◆ Outliers
- ◆ Ambiguous or contradictory data

Techniques to Handle Noise:

Technique	Description
Data Cleaning	Remove or correct incorrect/missing en-
Smoothing	Average noisy data (e.g. in time series)
Outlier Detection	Identify and remove unusual data points
Noise-Tolerant Algorithms	Use robust models (e.g. decision trees, SVM)

Exam Point Summary:

- ◆ Define noisy data
- ◆ State problems caused by noise
- ◆ Mention 2 methods to handle noise



Example:



In a decision tree for weather prediction:

A branch for 'If Wind = Medium & Humidity = 89%' might only apply to 1 training example.

Pruning would cut this branch, as it doesn't help with generalization.

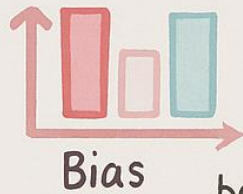
Benefits of Pruning:



Increases model accuracy on test data

- ◆ Avoids overfitting
- ◆ Increases model accuracy on test data

What is Bias-Variance Tradeoff



It is a fundamental concept in machine learning that describes balance between two types of errors a model can make:



-  Bias (Error from wrong assumptions)
-  Variance (Error from too much sensitivity to training data)



1. Bias – Too Simple

- Model makes strong assumptions
- Underfits the data
- Misses important patterns

Example: Predicting complex patterns using a straight line



2. Variance – Too Complex

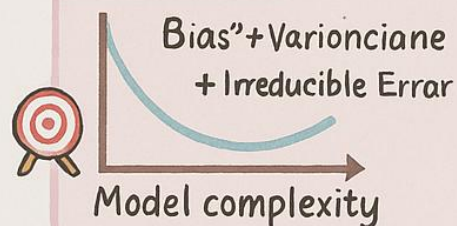
- Model is too sensitive to training data
- Overfits (memorizes noise and fluctuations)
- High error on unseen data
- ✓ Low training error
- ✗ High test error

⚖ The Tradeoff

If you reduce bias (make model more complex), variance increases
If you reduce variance (simplify model), bias increases

- ✓ You need to balance bias and variance to get the best performance!

Diagram:



🎯 Ideal-Model: "Archery Target"

Shohter	Bias	High Variance
Misses far from center	High Bias	Systematic error (underfitting)
Hits near center, tight	Low Bias	Good model!!

Summary Table:

Error Source	High Bias Low	High Variance
Error source	Wrong assumptions	Too flexible
Flexibility	Too rigid	Too
Training Error	High	Low
Test Error	High	High

What is PCA (Principal Component Analysis)?

PCA is an unsupervised dimensionality reduction technique used to reduce high-dimensional data into a smaller number of important variables-Principal Components –

Key Concepts

Term	Meaning
Dimensionality	Number of features (columns) in the dataset
Principal Component	New axes (formed) formed by combining original ones
Variance	How much data "spreads out" - PCA keeps features that explain more variance

Using PCA for Feature Selection

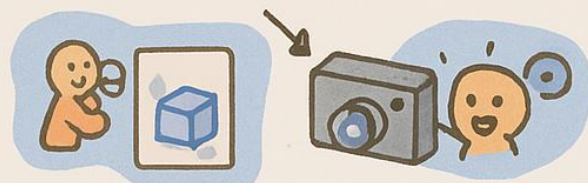
PCA doesn't "select" existing features - it creates new features (principal components) that summarize the most information.

✓ You use PCA for feature reduction, not feature ranking

Original Features	After PCA
Height, Weight, BMI	PC ₁ + 90% info

Why Use PCA?

- Removes redundant or less useful features
- Makes model faster and less complex
- Improves visualization (e.g, from 10 D to 2D)
- Helps avoid overfitting



Imagine a camera trying to take a picture of a 3D object

~~Imagine - choosing the best angle so you can still see the next principal clearly is 3~~

Steps for Feature Selection using PCA:

Step	Action	After PCA
Original Features	Apply PCA on dataset	PC ₁ = 90% info
Choose top k principal components	Top k principal components	PC ₂ + 5% info

What is Underfitting?

A model is said to be underfitting when it is too simple to learn the patterns in the training data, resulting in high error on both training testing set

Causes :

- Model is too basic
- Not enough training (too few epochs)
- Irrelevant features used
- Data not preprocessed or cleaned

Symptoms:

- High training error
- High testing error ✗

How to Avoid Underfitting?

Solution	Explanation
Increase model.. complexity	Use deeper decision trees, neural networks etc.
Train longer	Increase number of epochs or iterations
Add more relevant features.	Improve input data quality



Underfit =

"Undertrained + Too Simple"

A model is said to be overfitting when memorizes the training data including noise. instead of learning general pattern.

Causes:

- Model is too complex
- Too many features, not enough examples
- Trained too long



Symptoms:

- Very low training error ✓
- Very high test error ✗



Visual Comparison:

- ↳ Use Cross-validation
- Apply Regularization (L1/L2)
- Use Simpler model
- Reduce features or use PCA
- ↳ Early stopping during training

Visual Comparison:

Status	Train	Error	General
Underfitting	High	High	Poor
Good Fit	Low	High	Poor

Prevention of Overfitting

LINEAR REGRESSION

KEY IDEA:

Linear Regression is used to predict continuous values (eg., price, height, marks). It finds best straight line (regression line) that fits the data points

FORMULA:

$$y = mx + c \text{ or } w_1x + w_0$$

Variable	Description
y	Predicted output
x	Input feature
m or w_1	Slope/weight
c or w_0	Bias/intercept



EXAMPLE:

- Is email spam or not?
- Will a student pass or fail?
- Is a patient diabetic or not?

SIGMOID FUNCTION

$$P(y=1|x) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-xw_0}}$$

Variable	Description
$P(y=1 x)$	Probability of class 1

✓ USES:

- Binary classification (2 classes)
- Extended to multi-class classification (using Softmax)

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN LINEAR & LOGISTIC REGRESSION

Feature	Linear	Logistic Regression
Output Type	Continuous (Real numbers)	Categorical (Probabilities or 0/1)
Output Range	$-\infty$ to $+\infty$	Between 0 and 1
Function Used	Linear (straight line)	Sigmoid (S-curve) Classification tasks

★ is SVM ☁️

(Support Vector Machine)

Key Concepts

Term	Meaning
Hyperplane	A line (in 2D), plane (in 3D), or higher dimensional surface
Support Vectors	The data point closest to the hyperplane
Margin	The distance between hyperplane and support vectors
Maximum Margin	SVM aims to maximize distance for better generalization

Why Use SVM?

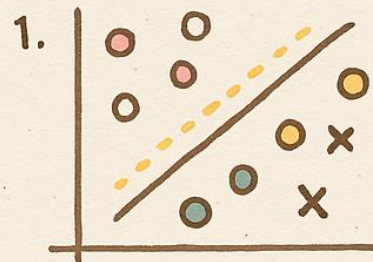
- Works well in high-dimensional spaces
- Effective when data is not linearly separable (uses kernel trick)

Types of SVM

Used when	Data can't be linearly separated
Non-linear SVM	Uses kernel trick to map data into higher dimensions where it can be linearly separated

SVM in 2D

(Simple Visualization Idea)



1. Find the widest possible gap between the two classes
2. Keep the line (hyperplane) in the middle
3. The closest dots on each side = support vectors

Kernel Trick

Converts non-linearly separable data into higher dimension

Good for text classification, image recognition, bioinformatics

Applications of SVM:

- ✓ Spam detection
- ✓ Handwriting recognition
- ✓ Face detection



What is a Decision Tree?

A Decision Tree is a supervised learning algorithm used for classification and regression. It splits the data into branches based on feature values until it reaches a decision (leaf node).

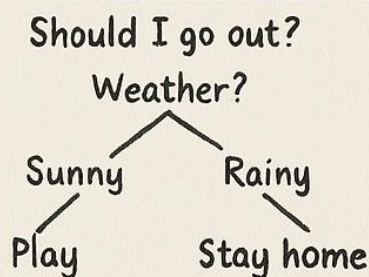


Simple Definition:

- A tree-like structure where:
- Each internal node = a test on a feature
- Each branch = a result of test
- Each leaf node = a class label (decision)



Real-Life Example:



Types of Decision Trees

Type	Used For
Classification Tree	Classification
Regression Tree	Continuous Value (e.g. salary)



Advantages

- Easy to understand and visualize



Key Terms:

Term	Meaning
Root Node	First feature split
Internal Node	A question/test on feature (e.g. Age ≥ 50 ?)
Leaf Node	Final decision/output (e.g. Yes/No, Class A/B)
Branch	Outcome of the test (True/False path)
Entropy	Measures impurity or randomness in the data
Gini Index	Another impurity measure (used in CART algorithm)



Advantages

- Can to understand and visualize
- No need for feature scaling
- Works for both numeric and categorical data
- Fast on small to medium datasets



Trick to Avoid Overfitting in Decision Trees:

- Use Pruning (cut branches that don't improve accuracy)
- Set max depth or min samples per leaf